F3 BUILDING SURVEYORS

BUILDING SURVEY REPORT

The Co-Proprietors per Trinity Factors

45 - 51 Caledonian Crescent, James Square, Edinburgh
Project Number: 21049
Date: 30-Nov-21
Revision: Not applicable

F3 BUILDING SURVEYORS
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45 - 51 CALEDONIAN CRESCENT, JAMES SQUARE, EDINBURGH

BUILDING SURVEY REPORT

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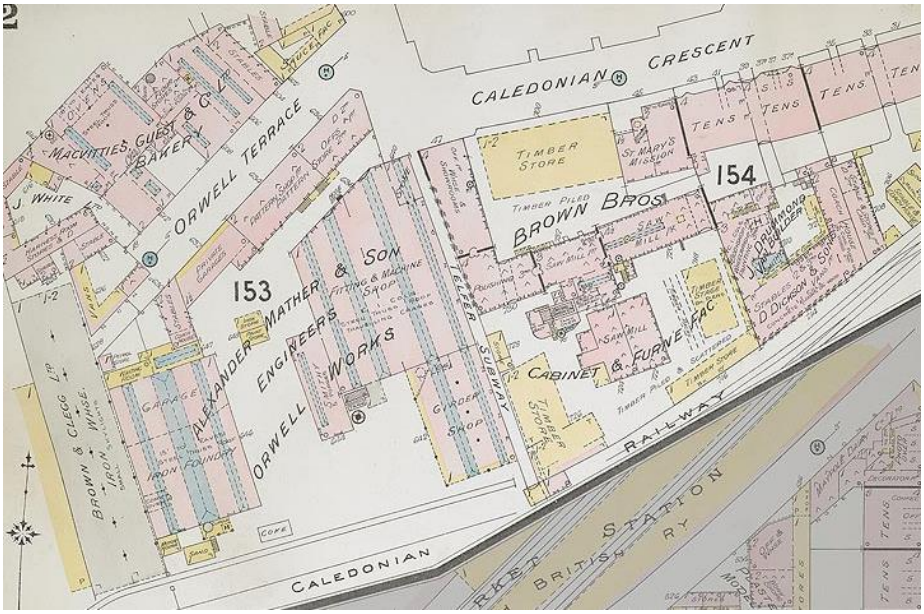
This report has been prepared by F3 Building Surveyors Limited with all reasonable skill, care and diligence, within the terms of the Contract with the Client. The report is confidential to the Client and F3 Building Surveyors Limited accepts no responsibility of whatever nature to third parties to whom this report may be made known.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. On behalf of The Co-Proprietors per Trinity Factors, we were requested to undertake a building fabric survey to the roof area of the property comprising 45-51 Caledonian Crescent, part of the James Square development, Edinburgh.

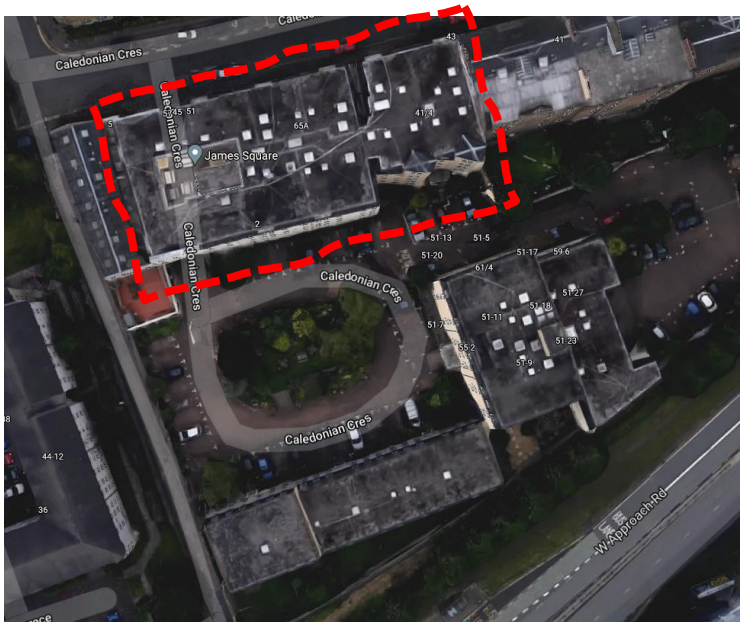
1.2. We undertook our survey on 14th October, this was undertaken by David Bonar, MRICS, Chartered Building Surveyor and Sally Orr, MRICS, Chartered Building Surveyor, with access provided by onsite co-ordinator.

1.3. The property comprises a flatted residential block within a larger development, the block in question is over six floors. Our understanding is that the properties are on the site of a former timber store and sawmill / furniture works (see map below). The property is not a listed building and neither is it within a Conservation Area.



1.4. The property appears to be traditionally constructed with a wet dash wall finish, slated mansard sections at the top floor and the roof is of a flat roof construction.

1.5. The property is located on Caledonian Crescent, Edinburgh.



1. INTRODUCTION (cont)

1.6. We were given access to the following areas:

1.6.1. External fabric: Please refer to our separate survey report with regard to repairs to the elevations. There may be an option to undertake joint elevation and roof repairs to save on the cost of scaffolding / access equipment, for the purpose of this report we have allowed for this as a standalone project with separate access costs.

1.6.2. Roof coverings: We were able to undertake an inspection via access through the viewing room / terrace to the top floor of the block at number 51. We were also able to undertake inspection utilizing the cherry picker in conjunction with the elevation surveys. We were able to access most areas of the slatework.

1.6.3. External curtilage: Not applicable for the purpose of our survey.

1.6.4. Internally we accessed the common stair areas to allow access up on to the roof.

1.7. Areas of no access: We gained access to all relevant areas for the purposes of the survey.

1.8. For the purposes of the report, the front elevation to the property on Caledonian Crescent is assumed to face north. All references to left hand side and right hand side are taken when viewing the relevant elevation from external facing the building.

1.9. We were not provided with any Health and Safety file nor the Operation & Maintenance Manual for the building. We have not been provided with any information for example builders estimates or the like.

1.10. Please note that this report is not intended for issue to contractors for pricing works. In the event that the owners decide to proceed with the works we would strongly recommend that full and comprehensive tender documentation be prepared, we can undertake this if required.

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS

2.1. The building is generally in a fair condition however the roof coverings now require some repair:

2.1.1. Flat roof: The main flat roof comprises a mastic asphalt finish, this is generally a hardwearing good quality roof covering, lasting 50+ years. The roof drains from the mid point to the platform edge with slatework mansard section. There is a roof terrace and viewing room, which are accessed from block 51. The roof terrace has slabs laid over the mastic asphalt finish, and the viewing room has a flat mastic asphalt roof finish.

There is a small flat roof area at lower level between blocks 51 and 65, which is accessed from the common stair of flat 51. This comprises mastic asphalt roof covering with limestone chips laid over. The flat roof has a drainage channel to an outlet. There is a small slated pitched roof section over the common stair, with a Velux window, access to this area is via a roof light within the common stair.

To the south between blocks 45 and 51, there is a small section of flat roof, this is mastic asphalt with chips laid over. We had limited access to this roof area due to the configuration of the roof.

2.1.2. To the small lower level section between 51 and 65 the condition of the mastic asphalt where visible is cracked, in the short term we would recommend that the limestone chips are removed, and the flat roof is repaired. We would recommend that the upstand to the perimeter is also increased at this time to 150mm, at the moment it is currently 65mm, which is less than the recommended details require. We would also include for new lead cover flashings in association with the repairs. As part of these works, we would also include for an improved drainage detail as the roof drainage from 51 drains down onto the flat roof.

The slatework to this section is poor and we would allow for a strip and re-slate in the short term. There is a Perspex window to the common stair and at the time of our inspection, there had been minor water ingress around the window to the common stair, we have allowed for re-seal of the Perspex in the short term. The Velux window is in fair condition, and we have not allowed for any works to this. There is a small flat roof section above the pitched roof, this is also mastic asphalt, and in a similar condition to the lower flat roof, to the roof adage, the detailing is poor as it is “dripping” down the lead flashing, rather than being neatly formed.

Towards the north (on Caledonian Crescent) there is a flat roof with 2 replaced roof lights, we were advised this is not part of the common roof areas, and therefore we have not included in our report.

Photo 01 – Outlet detail and minimal upstands to perimeter of the roof.

Photo 02 – Poor condition slatework, Perspex window to common stair.

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS (cont)

2.1.4. To the main flat roof areas the mastic asphalt appears to have had an aggregate finish (we have assumed limestone chips) laid over, these are generally no longer present and have possibly either been removed or simply been blown off over the years (there are still some bedded in the roof covering), this is a common finish to asphalt roof coverings. There has been a large feltwork repair carried out to the south of block 51. The roof has recently been re-painted with solar reflective paint.

2.1.5. The surface of the mastic asphalt is wrinkling and cracking to a number of the areas throughout the flat roof covering. There is also cracking to the upstands and generally the roof is appearing tired. At the time of our inspection there was a large section to the south of the block 51 which has been re-felted, there is some open / lifting joints to the feltwork which we have referred to Trinity Factors for repair. To the roof, there are sections of ponding which are in excess of 25-30mm deep in places, this would generally point to there being a possible sag in the roof, therefore we would recommend in the short term that this area is checked to make sure the roof remains watertight. There has been temporary repairs carried out to the south (rear) of block 45, to divert water at the pitched slated roof areas, we would recommend that if there are issues with water draining in this area, that a more substantial solution be put in place, we have included for this in the short term.

2.1.6. To the south (rear) of 45, there are 2nr small slated pitched roofs with uPVC guttering and timber fascia. The slated pitches are in a fair condition, we have allowed to overhaul in the medium term. The timber fascias require repairs in the short term.

2.1.7. To the roof at 51, there is a viewing deck which is a public area to be utilised by building users. The roof covering to this is mastic asphalt with slabs laid over. At the time of our inspection we were able to locate the outlet to the flat roof, this requires to be cleared out. We would recommend in the short term that the roof area is checked for additional outlets, and these are cleared. We had limited inspection to the roof deck below the slabbing however would assume that there are likely to be repairs required and therefore have included a sum in the short term. To the viewing deck there is a rendered perimeter wall, the render to this is poor and requires to be hacked off and renewed in the short term. We would also recommend that a storm drain / overflow is provided to the terrace as an early warning system for any flooding.

2.1.8. To the viewing room the mastic asphalt roof covering is in a similar condition to the main flat roof. There are timber fascia and uPVC guttering, these are in poor condition and require short term replacement / repairs.

2.1.9. Roof lights: There are roof lights throughout the roof area, we have allowed a sum for short term repairs including re-fixing of trims and liquid plastics coating around the roof lights.

2.1.10. Louvered vents: We would recommend that the fire risk assessment is checked as these appear to be smoke vents. Generally, the painterwork and timber repairs are required to the louvers.

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS (cont)

Photo 03 – Cracking to main flat roof.

Photo 04 – Feltwork repair joints lifting.

Photo 05 – Ponding water and temporary repair to rear of slated pitches.

Photo 06 – Blocked outlet to roof terrace.

2.1.11. Mansard roof sections: The slatework is in fair condition, we have allowed for in the short term to replace any broken, slipped or missing slates.

2.1.12. Fascias and soffits: We have included for maintenance painterwork and fascia repairs in the short term.

2.1.13. Trailing cables / aerials: Allow for tidying and removal of redundant in the short term.

2.1.14. Guttering: Allow for clear out and repairs in the short term, we have also included for guttering repairs to broken sections and leaking joints.

Photo 07 – Poor timberwork and guttering to viewing room.

Photo 08 – Rooflight requiring repairs to trims

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS (cont)

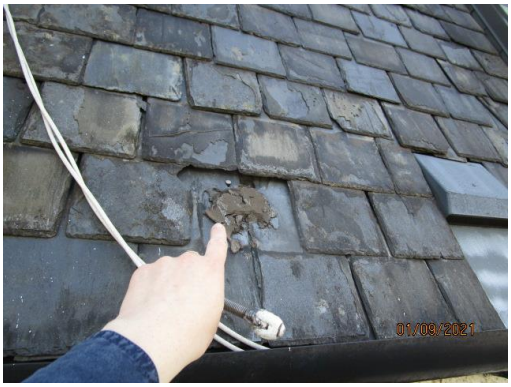


Photo 09 – Slatework requiring repairs – slate missing to mansard.

Photo 10 – Hole in gutter with loose laid felt "repair".

3. RECOMMENDED WORKS

3.1. Our recommendations would be to undertake the repairs as required to the following areas:

RED PRIORITY: IMMEDIATE / SHORT TERM (YEARS 1-2):

3.2. In terms of immediate / short term actions we would recommend the following:

3.2.1. Asbestos: We have included for an asbestos refurbishment survey to the roof prior to repairs.

3.2.2. Undertake repairs to the mastic asphalt, we would recommend prior to undertaking these repairs that a core is carried out to confirm that the roof build up is as it should be, i.e. a sheathing membrane is provided. Thereafter, recommendations are provided with regard to the anticipated lifespan of the roof. We have spoken to Lenaghan Roofing Services Ltd who up until recently, were the only local mastic asphalt contractor however they have recently stopped undertaking works. They are able to provide advice and recommendations with regard to the current roof area. We would recommend that this is carried out prior to undertaking any large scale works as the roof should have a life span left of approximately 10 – 20 years however that is fully dependent on the quality of the original installation.

3.2.3. Felt repairs: The contractor who undertook the repair works to the felt requested to return and re-do joints.

3.2.4. To the lower level roof between 51 and 65, repairs to the mastic asphalt and upgrading the outlet.

3.2.5. Clear out the viewing deck roof area including all drainage channels and provide storm overflow.

3.2.6. Undertake repairs to the upper roof to the viewing area including painterwork to fascia. Fascia repairs, new guttering and repairs to roof covering.

3.2.7. Slatework: Include for replacement of damaged, slipped and missing slates.

3.2.8. Guttering: Guttering repairs to uPVC gutters.

3.2.9. Roof lights: Allow for short term repairs to roof lights.

3.2.10. Painterwork: Allow for paintwork to all timberwork at high level including louvre vents.

AMBER PRIORITY: MEDIUM TERM (YEARS 3-5):

3.3. In terms of medium term actions, we would recommend the following:

3.3.1. Following initial core and recommendations as above, we would anticipate a requirement for an overlay of the existing roofing with a felt roof covering or liquid plastic type covering.

GREEN PRIORITY: LONGER TERM (YEARS 6-10):

3.4. In terms of longer term actions, we would recommend the following:

3.4.1. Assuming the works are carried out in the short and medium term ongoing maintenance will be required in the longer term. There will likely be a requirement for a strip and reslate, however we would anticipate that will be required 15-20 years.

4. CONCLUSION

4.1. In conclusion, based on our survey, repairs are required in the short term to the roof, and also in the medium term.

4.2. We refer you to our budget costs which highlight the short and medium term repairs required.

4.3. If you wish our further input or assistance in this regard, we would be delighted to do so.

4.4. We thank you for asking us to assist.

Prepared by F3 Building Surveyors Ltd.
30-Nov-21

Prepared by:	**SO**	Date:
Checked by:	**RS**	**3-Dec-21**

APPENDIX 1 – BUDGET COSTS

Description	Quantity	Units	Rate	Total	RED: Short Term	AMBER: Medium Term	GREEN: Longer Term
45 - 51 James Square Roof							
SUPERSTRUCTURE							
Roof							
Roof coverings							
Lower Level Between 51-65							
Flat Roof - Short Term Repairs. Including improved drainage outlet.	1	Item	2000	2,000.00	2,000.00		
Flat Roof - Core to determine build up.	1	Item	300	300.00	300.00		
Flat Roof - Upstand detailing to perimeter. Including leadwork coverflashing.	14	Days	300	4,200.00		4,200.00	
Slated Pitch - Strip and Re-slate.	2	m2	120	240.00	240.00		
Flat Roof - Medium Term Overlay.	51	m2	110	5,610.00		5,610.00	
Main Flat Roof							
Short Term - Core to check existing build-up	1	Item	600	600.00	600.00		
Short Term - Repairs following core, including check on ponding areas, replacing temporary repairs to rear etc.	1	Item	10000	10,000.00	10,000.00		
Short Term - Louvered Vents, timber repairs and painterwork	1	Item	500	500.00	500.00		
Short Term - Tidy trailing cables and remove redundant aerials / cables.	1	Item	500	500.00	500.00		
Medium Term - Overlay flat roof area.	729	m2	110	80,190.00		80,190.00	
Medium Term - Extra over for insulation	729	m2	40	29,160.00		29,160.00	
Slated Pitches							
Medium Term - Small Pitched roofs to rear (south) of block 45, overhaul.	15	m2	20	300.00		300.00	
Short Term - Timber Fascia Repairs	10	m	35	350.00	350.00		
Short Term - Mansard Roof areas. Replace slipped, missing and loose slates.	1	Item	3500	3,500.00	3,500.00		
Viewing Room Flat Roof							
Short Term - Repairs to flat roof, fascia, and guttering	1	Item	1000	1,000.00	1,000.00		
Medium Term - Overlay.	18	m2	110	1,980.00		1,980.00	
Roof Terrace							
Short Term - Lift Slabs, clear out outlets and undertake repairs. Provide Storm overflow.	1	Item	2000	2,000.00	2,000.00		
Medium Term - Overlay.	1	Item	3000	3,000.00		3,000.00	
Roof drainage							
Short Term Guttering - Repairs and clearing out.	1	Item	1500	1,500.00	1,500.00		
Roof lights							
Lower Level Between 51-65							
Seal Perspex window.	1	Item	30	30.00	30.00		
Main Flat Roof							
Short Term - Repairs.	1	Item	1000	1,000.00	1,000.00		

Description	Quantity	Units	Rate	Total	RED: Short Term	AMBER: Medium Term	GREEN: Longer Term
Medium Term - Replacement	30	No	800	24,000.00		24,000.00	
PRELIMINARIES							
Facilitating Works							
Toxic / Hazardous / Contaminated Material Treatment							
Toxic / Hazardous Material Removal							
Asbestos Refurbishment Survey	1	Item	500	500.00	500.00		
Main Contractor's Preliminaries							
Scaffolding / Work at height							
Scaffolding Short Term	1	Item	10000	10,000.00	10,000.00		
Scaffolding Medium Term	1	Item	30000	30,000.00		30,000.00	
Rope Access Short Term.	5	Days	1000	5,000.00	5,000.00		
Cherry Picker - Short Term	2	Days	500	1,000.00	1,000.00		
Management and General Preliminaries							
Short Term	6	wks	600	3,600.00	3,600.00		
Medium Term	16	wks	800	12,800.00		12,800.00	
SUB-TOTAL CONSTRUCTION COSTS				**234,860.00**	**43,620.00**	**191,240.00**	**0.00**
UNALLOCATED							
Unallocated							
Non-Construction Costs							
Professional Fees							
Short Term	1	Item	2000	2,000.00	2,000.00		
Medium Term	1	Item	4000	4,000.00		4,000.00	
TOTAL INCLUDING FEES				**240,860.00**	**45,620.00**	**195,240.00**	**0.00**
VAT			**20%**	**48,172.00**	**9,124.00**	**39,048.00**	**0.00**
TOTAL INCLUDING FEES AND VAT				**289,032.00**	**54,744.00**	**234,288.00**	**0.00**

APPENDIX 2 – STANDARD CONDITIONS

Content of the Report

In accordance with these terms the Surveyor will use his or her best endeavours to report upon:

a. The main aspects of the Property including assessing the site/location, the design, structural framework, fabric and services;

b. The grounds, boundaries and environmental aspects considered to affect the Property;

c. Any requirements for further investigation arising from the inspection.

Assumptions

Unless otherwise expressly agreed the Surveyor while preparing the Report will reasonably assume that:

a. The Building(s) (if for sale) is offered with vacant possession;

b. The Building(s) is connected to mains services with appropriate rights on a basis that is known and acceptable to the Client; and

c. Access to the Building(s) is as of right upon terms known and acceptable to the Client.

Scope of the inspection

A. Generally

a. The Surveyor will consider his or her advice carefully but is not required to advise on any matter the significance of which in relation to the Building(s) is not apparent at the time of inspection from the inspection itself.

b. The Surveyor will inspect diligently but is not required to undertake any action that would risk damage to the Building(s) or injury to himself, herself or any other party.

c. The Surveyor will not undertake any structural or other calculations.

d. The Surveyor will not produce a repair schedule, planned maintenance report, feasibility report or advise on design, procurement or project management unless expressly agreed with the client.

B. Accessibility

a. The Surveyor will inspect as much of the internal and external surface area of the building as is practicable but will not inspect those areas which are covered, unexposed or not reasonably accessible from within the site, or adjacent public areas.

b. The Surveyor is not required to move any obstruction to inspection including, but not limited to, fixtures, fittings and floor coverings.

c. The surveyor will not open up or cut into the building fabric without specific directions from the client. Such intrusive investigations, if instructed by the client, will be at the risk and liability of the client and will be assumed to be with agreement between the client and the building owner.

C. Floors

a. The Surveyor will lift accessible sample loose floorboards and trap doors, if any, which are not covered by heavy furniture, ply or hardboard, fitted carpets or other fixed floor coverings. The Surveyor will not attempt to cut or lift fixed floorboards or other floor fabric without the express permission of the owner.

D. Fixed covers or housings

a. The Surveyor will not attempt to remove securely fixed covers or housings without the express permission of the owner.

E. Roofs

a. The Surveyor will inspect the roof spaces if there is a safe working platform available to work from. Where no safe working platform or access is available, the roof spaces will not be inspected. Similarly, outer surfaces of the roof or adjacent areas will be inspected using binoculars, but will be excluded if they cannot be seen.

F. Boundaries, grounds and outbuildings

a. Where reasonable access is available the inspection will include boundaries, grounds and permanent outbuildings but will not include temporary buildings or structures.

G. Services

a. The Surveyor will carry out a visual inspection of the service installations where reasonably accessible. Drainage inspection covers will be lifted where they are reasonably accessible and it is safe and practicable to do so. No tests of the service installations will be carried out unless previously agreed, although general overall comments will be made where reasonably possible and practicable. The Surveyor will report if it is considered that tests are advisable. Specialist inspection of electrical installations or gas mains will not be undertaken.

H. Areas not inspected

a. The Surveyor will identify any areas which would normally be inspected but which he or she was unable to reasonably inspect.

I. Environmental and other issues

a. Particular noise, dust, flooding or contaminated land and disturbance affecting the Property will only be noted if it is reasonably significant at the time of the inspection or if specific investigation has been agreed between the Surveyor and the Client and confirmed in writing.

b. The Surveyor will report on any reasonably obvious health and safety hazards to the extent that they are apparent from elements of the Property considered as part of the inspection.

c. The Surveyor will not undertake a fire risk assessment or consider fire safety risks to the extent that they are apparent from elements of the property considered as part of the inspection.

J. Hazardous materials

a. Unless otherwise expressly stated in the Report, the Surveyor will assume that no deleterious or hazardous materials or techniques have been used in the construction of the Property. However, the Surveyor will advise in the Report if, in his or her view, there is a likelihood that deleterious material has been used in the construction and specific enquiries should then be made or tests carried out by a specialist.

b. Subject to section B to page 1, the Surveyor, based upon a limited visual inspection, will note and advise upon the presence of lead water supply pipes and asbestos.

c. The Surveyor will advise in the Report if, to the best of his or her knowledge, the Property is in an area where, based on information published by the National Radiological Protection Board, there is a risk of radon. In such cases the Surveyor may advise that tests should be carried out to establish the radon level.

d. The Surveyor will endeavour to advise if there are transformer stations or overhead power lines which might give rise to an electromagnetic field, either over the subject Property or visible immediately adjacent to the Property. The Surveyor is not required to assess any possible effect on health or to report on any underground cables.

K. Ground conditions

a. The Surveyor will not be required to comment upon the possible existence of noxious substances, landfill or mineral extraction implications, or other forms of contamination, nor will the Surveyor advise on the adequacy of the substratum for any particular purpose unless geotechnical tests or specialist advice are commissioned by the client.

L. Consents, approvals and searches

a. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that the Building or site is not subject to any unusual or onerous restrictions, obligations or covenants which apply to the Property or affect the reasonable enjoyment of the Property.

b. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that all planning, Building Regulations and other consents required in relation to the Property have been obtained. The Surveyor will not verify whether such consents have been obtained. Any enquiries should be made by the Client or the Client's legal advisers. Drawings and specifications will not be inspected by the Surveyor unless otherwise previously agreed.

c. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that the Property is unaffected by any matters which would be revealed by a Local Search and replies to the usual enquiries, or by a Statutory Notice, and that neither the Property, nor its condition, its use or its intended use, is or will be unlawful.

M. Exclusions

a. We have not inspected woodwork or other parts of the structure which are covered, unexposed or inaccessible and we are therefore unable to report that any such part of the property is free from defect.

b. We must stress that we have not carried out any investigation to determine whether any high alumina cement was used during the construction of the building inspected and we are therefore unable to report that the building is free from risk in this respect. In view of the possible potential danger connected with high alumina cement we strongly recommend that the appropriate investigations, inspections and tests be carried out immediately by a suitably qualified engineer.